# ‘Knowledge’

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## What is “Knowledge?”

Does anyone here not ‘know’ how to snap their fingers?

1. Press your middle finger pad tightly against your thumb pad.
2. Keep increase the pressure of your middle finger against your thumb.
3. Quickly move your thumb away, allowing your thumb to strike the fleshy part of your palm just below the thumb (known as the thenar eminence).

## What is “Knowledge?”

Would you say that someone who couldn’t snap their fingers, after reading those three steps, now “knows” how to snap their fingers?

If someone can snap their fingers, but couldn’t really describe how, would you say they “know” how to snap their fingers?

## What is “Knowledge?”

Before the anatomy portion of this course, you’d lived a long life of mostly not getting food or drink down your trachea. Could you have told me that’s because your epiglottis closes down over your larynx like a lid?

## Knowledge of Language

- the implicit knowledge that you utilize when producing and perceiving language without conscious thought.
- You may or may not be able to “introspect” and report on that knowledge, a.k.a. having “metalinguistic awareness.”
- With linguistic training, you may be able to expand what you are metalinguistically aware of.
- But, your attempts at metalinguistic insights can also be wrong.